

TrialDesk Secretary Manual

Create, prepare, run, score, place, export, and close an SDDA trial

PURPOSE: A practical, step-by-step operating manual for trial secretaries using SDDA TrialDesk. It follows Sporting Detection Dogs Association Master Rule Book v5.1, effective July 1, 2026, and the implemented TrialDesk workflow.

Manual version	Rules authority	Application scope
1.1 August 23, 2026	SDDA Master Rule Book v5.1	Scent, Games, and Combined trials

This manual explains the secretary's administrative workflow. The current SDDA rulebook, sanction approval, premium list, judge's instructions, and official SDDA forms remain controlling if they conflict with this guide.

Contents and operating sequence

- 1. Before TrialDesk: sanctioning, premium list, venue, judge, and supplies
- 2. Create the draft trial and select its format and dates
- 3. Configure offerings, FEO, judges, fees, and public details
- 4. Open entries, share the entry form, import CSV responses, and accept entries
- 5. Build and reorganize the running order
- 6. Apply component-specific move-ups
- 7. Generate and verify official score sheets
- 8. Trial-day desk workflow
- 9. Enter scores and make audited corrections
- 10. Review placements and Title Watch
- 11. Finances, official workbook, backup, and closeout
- 12. Troubleshooting and final checklists

RECOMMENDED PRACTICE: Complete a full mock trial before using TrialDesk at a live event. Confirm the entry form, one score sheet from every offered class, the running-order export, scoring, placements, workbook, backup, and printing on the equipment that will be used at the trial.

1. Before opening TrialDesk

1.1 Obtain SDDA approval

1. Confirm the judge and venue. Consult the judge about whether the search areas are suitable for every proposed level, component, and Game.

2. Submit the SDDA trial application. The rulebook requires the relevant application, judge, venue, and contact information at least 60 days before the trial.

3. Wait for publication. After approval and SDDA publication, prepare the Premium List and entry form. Do not distribute the public entry form earlier than allowed by the current SDDA instructions.

4. Document changes. If the judge, venue, offering, schedule, or Premium changes, notify entrants and SDDA promptly and be prepared to refund as required.

1.2 Gather setup information

Information	What to have ready
Trial identity	Trial name, host club, venue name, full address, and trial dates
Sanction details	SDDA trial number for each day when issued; judge name and substitutions
Offerings	Scent levels/components and/or Games; any FEO limits; capacities
Pricing	Scent component/three-component/Elite fees; separate Regular and FEO Games fees
Competitor information	Secretary contact, payment instructions, cancellation/refund terms
Operations	Search-area sequence, officials, timers, stewards, staging, printing, backup plan

1.3 Physical host checklist

- Prepared scent kit and separately stored clean supplies
- Correct official score sheets, clipboards, pens, calculators, stopwatches, and spares
- Safe search areas, clearly marked boundaries and starting marks
- Containers, vehicles/objects, distractions, replacement hide objects
- Enough judges, timers, stewards, gate staff, and a sight-screened staging area
- A posted running order and a check-in station
- Printer access or all required judge packets printed in advance

2. Create a trial

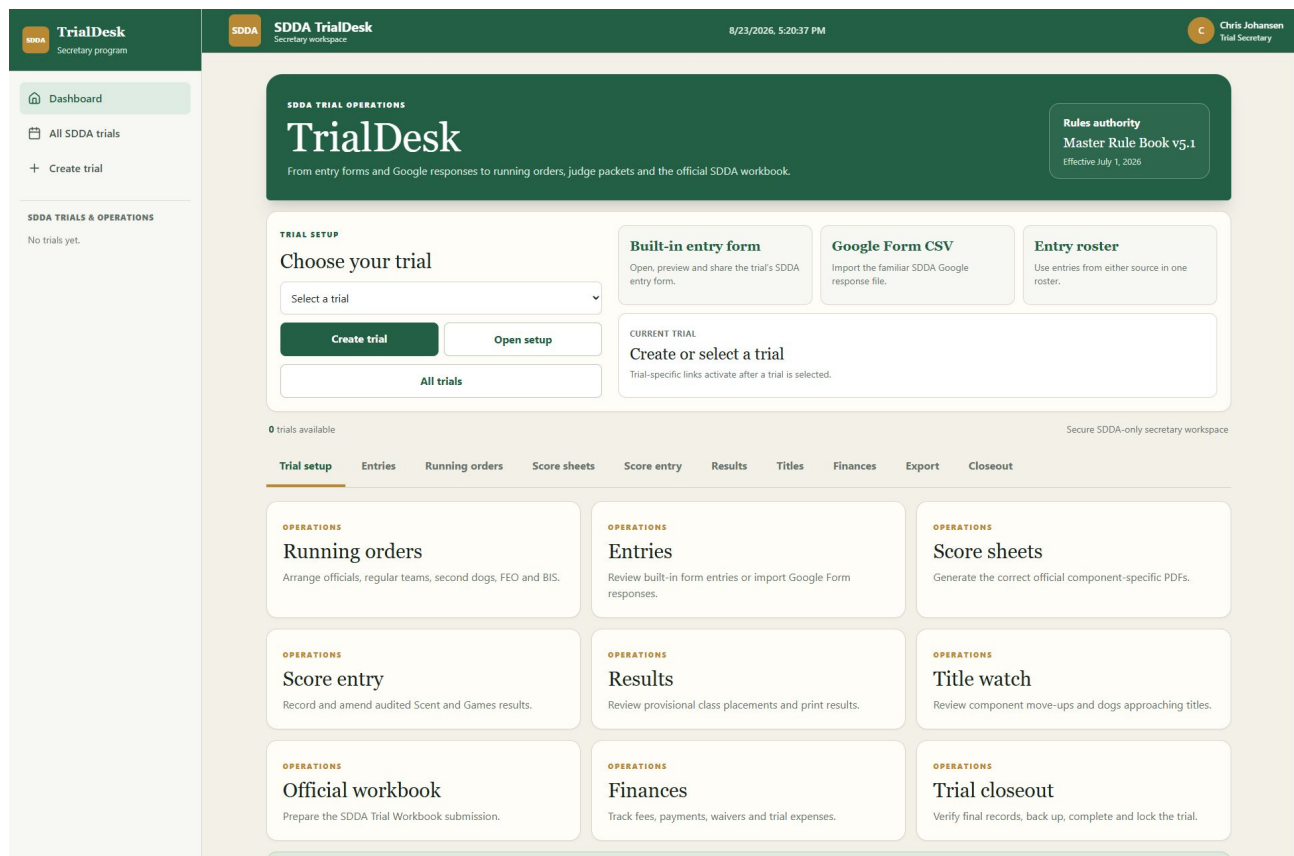


Figure 1. TrialDesk dashboard. Select an existing trial or start a new draft; the operation links follow the trial through setup, entries, running order, sheets, scoring, results, export, and closeout.

1. **Sign in.** Use the secretary account assigned to the trial.
2. **Select Create trial.** Use the left menu or the dashboard button.
3. **Enter trial details.** Use a recognizable trial name, the legal host/club name, and the complete venue address shown to competitors.
4. **Choose the trial format.** Choose Scent, Games, or Combined. Combined presents both workflows in the same trial workspace.
5. **Add the trial dates.** Enter unique dates in chronological order. Each becomes a separate trial day in TrialDesk. TrialDesk currently accepts one to four dates; this is an application limit, not an SDDA rule.
6. **Create Draft Trial.** A draft does not accept public entries. It can be completed as information arrives.

TrialDesk
Secretary program

SDDA TrialDesk
Secretary workspace

8/23/2026, 5:20:46 PM

Chris Johansen
Trial Secretary

Dashboard > Trials > Create

Create SDDA Trial

Set up a Scent trial, Games trial, or a Combined event with one-to-four days.

Trial details

SDDA host and venue information.

Trial name

Host club

Venue and full address

Facility name, street address, city, province, postal code

Shown to competitors on the entry form and trial documents.

Trial format

Choose what this event offers. Combined trials include both regular scent classes and SDDA Games.

☒ **Scent**

Started through Elite:
Container, Interior, and Exterior.

☐ **Games**

Aerial, Distance, Speed, and
Team games.

☐ **Combined**

Scent classes and Games in the
same trial.

Trial days

Select between one and four unique dates.

mm/dd/yyyy

+ Add trial day

Create the draft with the information you know now. On the next screen you will choose offerings and fees for each

Figure 2. Initial trial creation. Trial numbers, judges, offerings, fees, and public instructions are completed on the next screen and may be amended later.

RULE DISTINCTION: SDDA defines a trial as a single offering of any level within a 12-hour period with a unique trial number. A consecutive set of trials is a trial event. Enter the SDDA numbers exactly as issued for each TrialDesk day.

3. Configure the draft trial

3.1 Use the setup checklist

Open the trial. The setup screen tracks offerings, pricing, competitor-facing details, trial numbers, judges, and whether the entry form is open. Amber items may remain pending while the trial is a draft, but resolve them before final packets and exports.

3.2 Enter public details

1. **Enter the trial secretary.** Provide the name, monitored email address, and optional phone number.
2. **Write payment instructions.** State when payment is due, method, recipient, reference information, and the consequence of non-payment.
3. **Enter cancellation/refund terms.** Match the approved Premium List. Keep this text current if SDDA-approved arrangements change.
4. **Save public details.** These details appear on the competitor entry form.

3.3 Configure Scent offerings

- For each day, select the offered level: Started, Advanced, Excellent, or Elite.
- Within each level, select Container, Interior, and/or Exterior. Elite must offer all three components. If Started Container is offered, it must be held first and indoors.
- Do not choose Amateur or Working during trial creation. TrialDesk makes both streams available per selected component on the entry form; Elite has no stream.
- Enter a component judge when it differs from the day judge. Both Amateur and Working use that component judge.
- Select Allow FEO entries only where the organizer permits FEO. The public FEO checkbox appears only for those offerings.

3.4 Configure Games

- Select Aerial, Distance, Speed, and/or Team for each day.
- Enter the judge, capacity, Regular fee, and-only when permitted-enable FEO and enter its fee.
- Aerial entrants select High or Highfly. Team entrants identify a requested partner; the secretary finalizes pairings and order.
- Remember the rulebook-specific second-dog provisions: Aerial and Distance allow second dogs; Speed and Team do not.

3.5 Enter day details and fees

1. **Enter SDDA trial number and day judge.** They may be saved or replaced later if the assignment changes.
2. **Enter Scent pricing.** Set individual component, three-component package, and Elite fees. TrialDesk uses them to calculate accepted-entry balances.
3. **Save setup.** Do this before opening or copying the entry form link.

FEO: FEO is subordinate to Regular entries. SDDA permits FEO only after regular entries are accepted and allows the organizer to limit FEO by component or level when those limits are stated on the entry form.

5. Build and reorganize the running order

5.1 Generate the initial order

1. **Accept entries first.** Only accepted entries become operational runs.
2. **Open Running orders.** Select the trial day and generate or review the order for each level/component and Game.
3. **Apply SDDA group order.** TrialDesk orders Scent runs as Officials, Regular, Second dog, FEO, then BIS. Games show Regular before FEO.
4. **Review conflicts.** Check handlers with multiple dogs, officials who must run before duties, reactive-dog notes, Team partners, simultaneous rings, and travel between search areas.

5.2 Change group or position

- Use the run-group control when the secretary must mark Official, Second dog, FEO, or BIS. Competitors do not choose Official, Second dog, or BIS on the public form.
- Drag a run to its required position inside the applicable class/order. Save the order before leaving the page.
- Keep second dogs at the end of the component so the judge can change hides. Keep BIS after the second-dog group. Keep FEO after Regular and before BIS.
- If a judge approves a trial-day change in component order, Started Container still must be held first when offered.
- Re-check every component because the rulebook warns that a competitor's position may change between components.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
1	Saturday Runs														DAY TOTAL
2															106 RUNS
3	Trial #				Date 2026-06-06				Venue who knows				Judge		
4															
5	Saturday — Started														Class total: 19 runs
6	Container				6 ReacInterior				6 ReacExterior				7 Reac		

Figure 4. Header from an actual TrialDesk running-order export. Each day receives its own worksheet with a day total, trial metadata, level-coloured class bands, component columns, reactive indicators, and class totals. Review the complete workbook's names, streams, run groups, conflicts, and sequence before posting.

5.3 Export and post

1. **Save the running order.** Resolve any on-screen conflict warnings.
2. **Export running order XLSX.** Open it in Excel and inspect every day/level/component.
3. **Print or post copies.** Place a current copy at check-in and/or the handler staging area. Mark superseded copies clearly.

6. Component-specific move-ups

A qualifying component permits that same component at the next level: Started -> Advanced or Advanced -> Excellent. An Excellent title across all three components is required for Elite, so TrialDesk does not treat an individual Excellent component pass as an automatic Elite move-up.

6.1 When to approve a move-up

- The dog has a verified qualifying result in the same lower-level component.
- The destination level/component is offered on the relevant trial day.
- The move-up does not duplicate the same component in the same trial.
- The stream remains correct: after a processed title, continued entries at the titled level must be Working; at the next level the dog may again compete as Amateur unless the handler/dog otherwise belongs in Working.
- The secretary has evidence even if the qualification occurred at an earlier trial. Record the source in the activity/audit context.

6.2 Apply the move-up in TrialDesk

- 1. Open Running orders.** Choose the day containing the run to be changed.
- 2. Find the component run.** Confirm dog, handler, day, stream, and current level.
- 3. Select Move up.** Review the confirmation showing the old and new level.
- 4. Confirm and regenerate.** TrialDesk records the previous level, approval time, and approving user, then places the run in the destination offering.
- 5. Reorganize both affected orders.** A move-up changes class counts and may create handler or official conflicts. Drag, save, re-export, and repost the affected order.
- 6. Undo only for a genuine correction.** Use Undo move-up to return the run to its recorded prior level; the change remains auditable.

DO NOT INFER TITLES: Title Watch is an aid. A component move-up requires verified eligibility; a championship or Gold calculation must rely on official SDDA records, not competitor self-reporting.

7. Generate official score sheets

7.1 Prerequisites

- Entries are accepted and unwanted entries are waitlisted/withdrawn/cancelled
- Running order and all approved move-ups are saved
- Trial number, date, judge, dog call name, breed, SDDA number, stream, and formal alerts are correct
- The printer can print the official page size at 100% without fit-to-page distortion

7.2 Export Scent sheets

- 1. Open Score sheets.** Confirm the displayed count against the accepted Scent run count.
- 2. Choose the required packet.** Export the prefilled official PDF for the selected trial/day or offered set.
- 3. Inspect representative pages.** Open at least one page for every offered level/component combination-not merely one page per level.
- 4. Verify mapped fields.** Check trial number/date, call name, breed, SDDA number, formal alerts, stream checkbox, FEO marker, and footer sequence.
- 5. Print working and spare copies.** Provide originals to the judge and copies for any shadow judge according to SDDA requirements.

 SDDA		Excellent Score Sheet		Containing	
Host/Secretary to complete:		TRIAL # T-123		TRIAL DATE: 2026-06-06	
Dog's name: Sample Dog		Breed: All Canadian			
Dog's SDDA number: 12345		Formal alerts: Nose freeze		/ Look back	
CONTAINER SCORES:		Odour: Wintergreen, Pine, Thyme		Time limit: 3 minutes	
Strain: Amateur		☐ Working			
Find 1		Yes = 5 No = NQ			
Alert 1		Excellent = 5 points Deductions for: ☐ damages hide ☐ bothers hide substantially ☐ minimal change of behaviour ☐ none seen			
Find 2		Yes = 5 No = NQ			
Alert 2		Excellent = 5 points Deductions for: ☐ damages hide ☐ bothers hide substantially ☐ minimal change of behaviour ☐ none seen			
Find 3		Yes = 5 No = NQ			
Alert 3		Excellent = 5 points Deductions for: ☐ damages hide ☐ bothers hide substantially ☐ minimal change of behaviour ☐ none seen			
Dog's Search Performance		Excellent = 15 points Deductions for: ☐ lacks focus/distracted ☐ passes hide after sniffing it ☐ disregards handler direction ☐ noticeably damages or opens hide			
Handler Search Performance		Excellent = 15 points Deductions for: ☐ poor control of dog or leash ☐ handler reads dog poorly ☐ inconsistent search sequence ☐ moves objects without permission ☐ contaminates search area ☐ rough handling			
NQs: ☐ Timed out ☐ False Alert (called) or No find ☐ Stress/pain ☐ Eliminated in search area ☐ Left search area ☐ Handler withdrew ☐ Harsh handling (abusive or repeated verbal/physical corrections) ☐ Spaced hide before alert was called ☐ Prohibited Equipment ☐ Disturbed search area so hide is unable to be determined					
Comments: 		Time: 		Total score: /60	
Judge's name: 		Signature: 			

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SDDA Elite Score Sheet		Containers	
Host/Secretary to complete: _____		TRIAL# T-123	TRIAL DATE: 2026-06-06
Dog's name: Sample Dog		Breed: All Canadian	
Dog's SDDA number: 12345		Formal alerts: Nose freeze / Look back	
CONTAINER COMPONENT		Odour: Wintergreen/Pine/Thyme	
Time Limit: 3 minutes			
Finds 10 2 to 4 hides Formal Alerts 10	Number of hides: All found = 10 No = NQ ☐ Hide 1 ☐ Hide 2 ☐ Hide 3 ☐ Hide 4 Deductions for: ☐ Hide 1 ☐ Hide 2 ☐ Hide 3 ☐ Hide 4 ☐ damages hide ☐ bothers hide substantially ☐ minimal change of behaviour ☐ none seen		
Dog's Search Performance 20	Deductions for: ☐ lacks focus/distracted ☐ passes hide after sniffing it ☐ disregards handler direction ☐ noticeably damages objects		
Handler Search Performance 20	Deductions for: ☐ poor control of dog or leash ☐ handler inhibits dog ☐ inconsistent search plan ☐ moves objects without permission ☐ contaminates search area ☐ rough handling		
NOB: D Timed out D False Alert (called) or No find D Excused for stress/pain D Eliminated in search area D Left search area D Handler withdrew D Harsh handling (abusive or repeated verbal or physical corrections) D Exposes scent container before alert was called D Disturbed search area to extent that judge cannot identify hide D Prohibited equipment			
Time: ____ _		Total score: = 50	
Judge's name: _____		Judge's signature: _____	
Saturday - Elite Container - Run 112 FINAL ELITE SCORE			
Trial score to complete:			
SCORES: Container ____ + Interior ____ + Exterior ____ = ____/200 % ____ _ ☐ Completed title			
Total time: ____			

8. Run the trial: secretary desk sequence

8.1 Before competitors arrive

- Print/post the latest running orders and label each revision.
- Sort score sheets in run order by day, level, component/stream, and group.
- Prepare check-in list, registration-pending list, payment list, volunteer assignments, incident materials, ribbons, and spare supplies.
- Confirm search-area order with the judge. Started Container, if offered, is first and indoors.
- Keep clean scent supplies separate from previously scented items; hides are the judge's responsibility unless arrangements were made.

8.2 Check-in

- 1. Confirm identity.** Verify handler, dog call name, SDDA registration number/card, and any pending correction.
- 2. Confirm operational notes.** Ask about BIS, reactive-dog handling, accommodations, withdrawals, volunteer duties, second dogs, and Team partner changes.
- 3. Confirm order.** Tell the competitor that position may differ by component and direct them to the posted order.
- 4. Record changes immediately.** Update the entry/run group/order in TrialDesk and replace affected printed postings.

8.3 During each component

- Officials run before duties when their duties can be temporarily reassigned.
- Regular entries run before second dogs; the judge changes hide location(s) for the second-dog group.
- FEO runs after Regular entries and before BIS. BIS runs last and must follow the current SDDA equipment requirements.
- The steward calls teams from a staging area without visual access to the search area.
- The judge completes score and time, signs the sheet, and returns it to the secretary. The secretary may total the sheet.
- All teams complete the component before score sheets are released/presented.

8.4 Between components or days

Record results, identify verified move-ups, change the next running order, re-run conflict checks, save, export, and repost. Never rely on handwritten changes alone when the next score packet or official workbook will be generated from TrialDesk.

9. Enter scores and corrections

9.1 Scent scoring

1. **Open Score entry.** Only accepted runs appear.
2. **Select the exact run.** Match day, level, component, stream, dog, and handler to the signed sheet.
3. **Enter result.** Choose Qualifying, Non-qualifying, Absent, Withdrawn, or Excused as appropriate.
4. **Enter score and time.** For Qualifying/NQ results, transcribe the signed totals and time. Started components total 30/40/30; Advanced, Excellent, and Elite total 60/80/60.
5. **Save.** Every initial save and correction is recorded in the activity journal.

9.2 Games scoring

Select Pass, Fail, Absent, Withdrawn, or Excused and enter the official time where applicable. Games are not numerically scored. Match Team results to the finalized pair and Aerial results to the correct High/Highfly category.

9.3 Correcting a score

- Keep the signed sheet as the authority
- Open the same run, amend only the incorrect fields, and save
- Confirm that Results, Title Watch, Finances (if status changed), and the workbook now reflect the correction
- Use Activity to identify who changed the result and compare before/after values

PAPER CONTROL: Retain and distribute score-sheet copies according to current SDDA instructions. TrialDesk's digital audit supports-not replaces-the signed official sheet.

10. Placements, results, and titles

10.1 Provisional placements

Open Results after scoring. TrialDesk separates Scent by day, level, component, and stream. It includes qualifying runs only, ranks highest score first, then faster time, and excludes FEO. Exact score/time ties share a place. Games placements include passing Regular entries and rank faster time first; FEO is excluded.

- 1. Check completion badge.** Resolve missing scores before treating placements as final.
- 2. Compare with signed sheets.** Spot-check leaders, ties, NQs/fails, absences, withdrawals, and FEO exclusions.
- 3. Print / Save PDF.** Use the results page print control for posting or presentation.

10.2 Title Watch

Title Watch combines current accepted/scored entries with the latest public SDDA dog-history workbook snapshot. It highlights historical component Qs, possible same-trial Special titles, processed titles requiring Working at that level, and component-specific opportunities.

- A standard Started/Advanced/Excellent title requires a qualifying score in Container, Interior, and Exterior at that level.
- An untitled dog passing all three components of a level at the same trial may earn the Special designation.
- Elite requires all three components passed at the same trial.
- A Games title requires three passes in that Game; Games Championship requires titles in at least three Games.
- Gold/championship progress is not accepted from competitor self-reporting. Confirm it against detailed official SDDA records.

AUTHORITY: Title Watch is planning support, not SDDA title issuance. If a dog is unmatched, history is incomplete, or a title affects stream eligibility, verify with SDDA before representing the status as official.

11. Finances, workbook, backup, and closeout

11.1 Finances

- 1. Review expected fees.** TrialDesk calculates accepted-entry amounts from Scent and Games pricing, including separate Games FEO fees.
- 2. Record payments.** Enter collected amounts and payment details consistently; do not count received-but-unaccepted entries as earned entry revenue.
- 3. Record expenses.** Add judges, venue, supplies, ribbons, printing, mileage, meals, and other operating costs with meaningful descriptions.
- 4. Review judge breakdown.** Use the judge section to verify assignments and judge-related costs by day/offering.
- 5. Print/export the financial statement.** Reconcile expected, collected, outstanding, waived/refunded, expenses, and net before closeout.

11.2 Official SDDA workbook

- 1. Finish accepted-entry scoring.** Resolve registration numbers, trial numbers, judges, results, scores, and times.
- 2. Open Official workbook.** Read blockers and warnings. Correct source data rather than editing around a blocker.
- 3. Export each day group.** The official workbook has two day sections. TrialDesk groups a 3-4 day event into separate one/two-day workbook exports.
- 4. Open in Excel.** Allow original formulas to recalculate. Review Trial Info, level sheets, Games, Summary, High-in-Trial, fees, labels, formatted results, and the embedded SDDA Dogs registry.
- 5. Submit outside TrialDesk.** TrialDesk downloads a completed copy; it does not upload directly to SDDA. Follow SDDA's current submission/email instructions.

11.3 Backup and closeout

- 1. Open Trial closeout.** Resolve red blockers and review amber warnings.
- 2. Download complete trial backup.** Store the JSON backup with the final workbook, results, running order, financial statement, and retained score-sheet records.
- 3. Complete and lock.** Completion prevents operational edits. Use Reopen only for an authorized correction and repeat exports afterward.

ARCHIVE: Keep a durable copy outside the browser. A downloaded backup is only useful if it is stored in a known, backed-up location and can be associated with the correct trial number/date.

12. Troubleshooting and control checklists

12.1 Common problems

Symptom	Secretary action
First login fails; Retry works	Synchronize Windows date/time and time zone; close tabs and sign in again. The production login should use a full authenticated navigation.
Trial or Finances unavailable	Confirm the signed-in profile has access to the trial and that the required migrations were applied.
Entry absent from order/sheets	Confirm the entry is Accepted, not merely Received; verify at least one valid run and offering.
CSV row rejected	Read the row-specific error; correct header mapping, identity, day, level, component, stream, or duplicate data.
FEO option missing	Enable Allow FEO entries for that exact offering and save setup. Regular remains the default.
Move-up unavailable	Confirm lower-level component qualification, destination offering, and permitted next level. Elite requires the Excellent title.
Wrong sheet count	Compare accepted operational runs; exclude waitlisted/withdrawn/cancelled entries and check every imported selection.
PDF fields misaligned	Stop printing and report the exact level/component/Game. Each official template has its own mapping.
Workbook blocker	Correct the underlying trial/entry/score data, then export a fresh untouched official workbook copy.

12.2 Final pre-trial checklist

- ☐ All intended entries accepted and balances reviewed
- ☐ Registration-pending list resolved or actively controlled
- ☐ Every run assigned to the correct day/level/component/stream/group
- ☐ Officials, second dogs, FEO, and BIS sequenced correctly
- ☐ Conflict checks reviewed after every move-up and manual reorder
- ☐ One page from every score-sheet template visually checked
- ☐ Running order exported, printed, and posted
- ☐ Desk supplies, spare sheets, timers, ribbons, and backup equipment ready

12.3 Final closeout checklist

- ☐ All signed sheets returned and results entered
- ☐ Placements reviewed; FEO excluded
- ☐ Title opportunities reviewed against official history
- ☐ Payments and expenses reconciled
- ☐ Official workbook exported, recalculated in Excel, and reviewed
- ☐ Results, workbook, finances, activity, and running order archived
- ☐ Complete JSON backup downloaded
- ☐ Trial completed and locked after all required submissions are ready

Sources and scope notes

SDDA Master Rule Book v5.1 (effective July 1, 2026)

SDDA Rules and Rulebook page

SDDA website

Application behavior was verified against the current K:\TrialManager implementation, its database migrations, rule modules, score-sheet mappings, running-order export, scoring and results logic, official workbook exporter, financial ledger, activity journal, and closeout workflow as of August 23, 2026.

MAINTENANCE: Revise this manual whenever SDDA publishes a new rulebook, official score sheet, Games form, results workbook, fee schedule, or submission instruction-or whenever TrialDesk changes a workflow shown here.